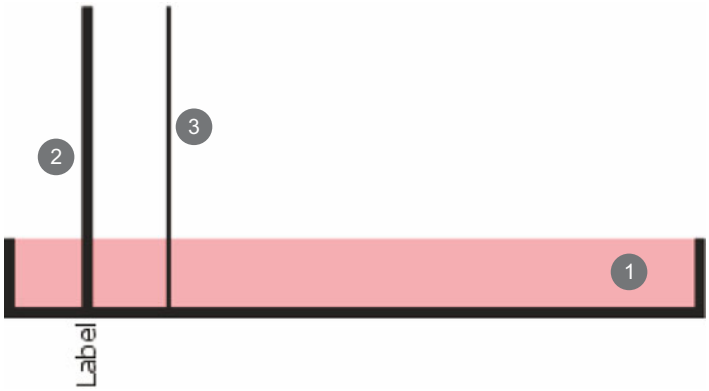


Figure 4.6 Elements of an axis created from `d3.svg.axis` are ❶ a `<path.domain>` with a size equal to the extent of the axis, ❷ a `<g.tick.major>` that contains a `<line>` and a `<text>` for each major tick, and ❸ a `<line.tick.minor>` for each minor tick (this will only be the case when using the deprecated `tickSubdivide` function in D3 version 3.2 and earlier). Not shown, and invisible, is the `<g>` element that's called and in which these elements are created. In our example, region 1 is filled with black and none of the lines have strokes, because that's the default way that SVG draws `<line>` and `<path>` elements.

This may seem counterintuitive, but SVG is meant to be paired with CSS, so it's better that elements don't have any "helpful" styles assigned to them, or you'd have a hard time overwriting those styles with your CSS. For now, we can set the domain path to `fill:none` and the lines to `stroke: black` using `d3.select()` and `.style()` to see what we're missing, as shown in figure 4.7.

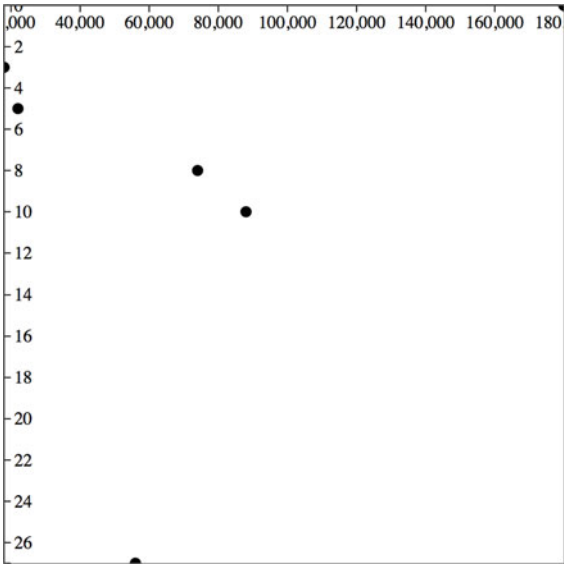


Figure 4.7 If we change the `<path.domain>` fill value to `"none"` and set its and the `<line>` stroke values to `"black"`, we see the ticks and the stroke of `<path.domain>`. It also reveals our hidden datapoint.